

RESISTANCE WEAPONS AND EQUIPMENT

Formed in July 1940, the British Special Operations Executive (SOE) was given the task of conducting irregular warfare throughout German-occupied Europe, providing support to local resistance movements. SOE placed a premium on lightweight, covert communications equipment, so that when its agents were operating behind enemy lines they could maintain contact with Britain. There was also a requirement for stealth weapons that could silently eliminate sentries or assassinate selected individuals. SOE was subsequently joined in its espionage operations by the American Office for Strategic Services (OSS), which placed a similar emphasis on specialist weapons.



RADIO ANTENNA

Headset

Microphone

Cable

DUPLEX TRANSCEIVER

◀ SOE S-PHONE TRANSCEIVER

Date c.1942
Origin UK
Type Ultra-high frequency duplex radio telephone

A miniaturized transmitter and receiver, the S-Phone weighed just 7kg (15lb), and enabled an agent to speak to the pilot of an aircraft 48km (30 miles) away at a height of up to 3,050m (10,000ft).



Radio concealed in leather suitcase

▶ SOE TYPE 3 (MK II) SUITCASE RADIO

Date c.1942
Origin UK
Type Portable transmitter/receiver station

Designed for agents working in enemy territory, the radio could transmit and receive messages to ranges of up to 800km (500 miles). It contained a modular receiver, transmitter, power supply unit, and miniature Morse key.

▶ SOE JUMP SUIT

Date 1941
Origin UK
Material Weatherproofed cotton

Designed for use by covert-action personnel parachuting into occupied territory, the camouflage suit protected the clothing underneath from damage. It also had numerous pockets to hold vital equipment.



Inner pockets to hold kit securely

Full-length zip to allow quick removal of jump suit